DAILY QUIZ · 12 NOVEMBER 2026 · 9 MIN READ

Garmin Forerunner 165 vs 265 vs 965

The Forerunner is Garmin's running and triathlon watch line. Three models cover most of our customers: the 165, the 265 and the 965. This brief explains why a customer needs one, what separates the three, and what the newer 170, 570 and 970 change.

1. Why use a watch like this

- **Accurate pace and distance** from GPS, without carrying a phone.
- **Heart rate from the wrist**, all day and during training.
- **Training guidance**: daily suggested workouts, structured workouts, race time predictions.
- **Recovery**: sleep, HRV status and a morning report tell the rider whether to push or rest.
- **One record of everything** in Garmin Connect, which also sends rides and runs to Strava.
- **For cyclists**: it records rides, pairs with a heart rate strap and sensors, and is the only device that also covers the swim and the run.

A phone app can track a run. It cannot give wrist heart rate, last a week on a charge, survive rain and sweat, or tell the rider how recovered they are.

2. The three models side by side

SPEC	FORERUNNER 165	FORERUNNER 265	FORERUNNER 965
Case	43 mm	46 mm (265S: 42 mm)	47 mm
AMOLED display	1.2 inch	1.3 inch (265S: 1.1 inch)	1.4 inch
Weight	39 g	47 g (265S: 39 g)	53 g
Bezel	Polymer	Polymer	Titanium
Battery, smartwatch	Up to 11 days	Up to 13 days (265S: 15)	Up to 23 days
Battery, GPS	Up to 19 hours	Up to 20 hours (265S: 24)	Up to 31 hours
GPS	Single-band	Multi-band with SatIQ	Multi-band with SatIQ
Triathlon and multisport mode	No	Yes	Yes
Cycling power meter support	No	Yes	Yes
Training Readiness	No	Yes	Yes
Music on the watch	Only on the 165 Music	Yes	Yes
Full-colour maps	No	No, follows a course line only	Yes, built in

Storage	–	8 GB	32 GB
Garmin India MRP	₹28,299 (165 Music: ₹33,990)	₹55,399 (265 and 265S)	₹74,299
Our price from	₹25,990	₹29,990 (Black)	₹39,990 (Black)

MRP is from the Garmin India website and our price is from our own website, both on 12 November 2026. Offer prices apply to some colours only, so check the site before you quote.

3. Terms the customer will ask about

- **Multi-band GPS**: the watch listens to satellites on two frequencies. It holds an accurate track between tall buildings, under trees and in valleys, where single-band GPS drifts.
- **SatIQ**: the watch switches to multi-band only when it needs to, which saves battery.
- **Training Readiness**: one score each morning from sleep, recovery time, HRV and recent training load. It answers "should I train hard today?"
- **Triathlon mode**: one activity that records swim, bike and run with the transitions, changed by a button press.
- **ClimbPro** (965): shows each climb on a route with the distance and gradient remaining.
- **Real-time stamina** (965): shows how much the rider has left during an effort.
- **Training load ratio, Endurance Score and Hill Score** (965): longer-term training measures the 265 does not have.

4. Who each one is for

- **Forerunner 165**: the first proper running watch. New runners, 5 km to half marathon, gym and general fitness. Light and simple. Not for triathletes, and not for a cyclist who uses a power meter.
- **Forerunner 265**: the serious runner and the first-time triathlete. It adds multi-band GPS, triathlon mode, power meter support and Training Readiness. The 265S is the same watch in a smaller case for smaller wrists, and it has the longer battery.
- **Forerunner 965**: marathon, ultra and long-distance triathlon. Maps for unfamiliar routes, the longest battery, ClimbPro, stamina and a titanium bezel.

The questions to ask: Which sports? Do you swim, bike and run in one event? Do you use a power meter? How long is your longest event? Do you train or race on routes you do not know? What size is your wrist?

5. Three sales rules

- A triathlete or a power meter user starts at the 265. Never sell them the 165.
- Maps and events longer than about 15 hours point to the 965.
- If the customer only runs on known routes and wants good data, the 265 is enough. Do not oversell the 965.

6. The newer models, briefly

NEW MODEL	FOLLOWS	WHAT CHANGED

Forerunner 170	165	Launched in May 2026. Same 1.2 inch AMOLED with slimmer bezels, more than 50 extra workout modes, Smart Wake Alarm and Garmin Fitness Coach. Battery up to 10 days. A 170 Music version adds music and Wi-Fi. Garmin India groups it with the new entry-level Forerunner 70, which is ₹32,990. The 170 has no India price listed yet.
Forerunner 570	265	42 mm and 47 mm sizes, aluminium bezel, a brighter display, a speaker and microphone for calls from the wrist, and Garmin's newest heart rate sensor. Still no maps, no flashlight and no ECG. Battery up to 11 days on the 47 mm. ₹67,990.
Forerunner 970	965	Sapphire glass and titanium bezel, a built-in LED flashlight, ECG, speaker and microphone, maps and 32 GB. Adds Running Tolerance, and running economy with the HRM 600 strap. Battery up to 15 days. ₹92,990 on Garmin India.

Newer does not mean longer battery. The brighter screens and speakers cost battery: the 570 lasts up to 11 days against 13 on the 265, and the 970 up to 15 against 23 on the 965. For an ultra runner or a 600 km brevet rider, the 965 can still be the better watch. They are also much better value today: the 570 is ₹67,990 against ₹29,990 for the 265 in Black, and the 970 is ₹92,990 against ₹39,990 for the 965 in Black.

7. What to sell with the watch

A chest heart rate strap for accurate intervals and for cycling, a screen protector, a spare charging cable, and for cyclists a handlebar mount or a bike computer, since a watch on the wrist is hard to read while riding.

Remember these

- 165: first running watch. No triathlon mode, no power meter support, single-band GPS.
- 265: multi-band GPS, triathlon mode, power meters, Training Readiness. 265S is the small size.
- 965: maps, ClimbPro, titanium bezel, up to 23 days and 31 hours of GPS.
- Newer models: 170 follows the 165, 570 follows the 265, 970 follows the 965. Newer does not mean longer battery.